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CHICAGO CAMPAIGN

It is reasonable to believe that if the problems of Chicago, the nation's second largest city, can be solved, they can be solved everywhere.

JULY 26, 1965
King leads march to Chicago City Hall and addresses a rally sponsored by Chicago's Coordinating Council of Community Organizations (CCCO)

JANUARY 7, 1966
Announces the start of the Chicago Campaign

JULY 10
At "Freedom Sunday" rally at Soldier's Field, launches drive to make Chicago an "open city" for housing

JULY 12–14
Racial rioting on Chicago's West Side results in two deaths and widespread destruction

AUGUST 5
Angry whites attack civil rights march through Chicago's southwest side

AUGUST 26
Arranges "Summit Agreement" with Mayor R. Daley and other Chicago leaders

In the early summer of 1965 we received invitations from Negro leaders in the city of Chicago to join with them in their fight for quality integrated education. We had watched this movement with interest, and members of the staff of the Southern Christian Leadership Conference had maintained constant communication with the leadership. As a result of meetings between members of my staff and leaders of Chicago civil rights organizations, I agreed to accept the invitation to spend some time in Chicago, beginning July 24.